

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1997-02-12

we convey our warmest greetings to the friends from Australia, Japan and other countries of the Pacific who have come together at the Seminar on the Spiritual Axis being held in Sydney under the auspices of the National Spiritual Assemblies of Australia and Japan.

This meeting is being convened at a time when the creative energies released by Bahá'u'lláh are giving rise to fundamental changes in the condition of humanity in your region, breaking down age-old barriers to the spread of the faith and propelling the believers forward to gather the harvest.

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Message from The Universal House of Justice

560 from seeds sown as long ago as the concluding years of the Apostolic Age of the cause.

The spiritual axis with which your deliberations will be concerned lies in an area of great strategic value to the future progress of the faith. It is positioned at the interface between the largest and most populous land mass in the world and an ocean extending over no less than one third of the surface area of the planet, within which are scattered island groups of diverse cultures. Sustained pursuit of the teaching work will not only immensely reinforce the human resources available to the cause, but will also, in due course, attract worldwide attention to the faith through the influence of the Teachings on the peoples of the small island nations of the Pacific. It is our hope that, at this meeting, you will consolidate the basis for collaboration in the years and decades ahead through consultation on the challenges and opportunities which now lie before you, and through further reinforcement of the bonds of love and fellowship which unite you in your services to the faith. By the formulation of plans for cooperative endeavors aimed at strengthening the national communities of this region and fulfilling the needs of the four year plan, you can lay the foundation for dazzling

victories in the future.

our prayers will be offered in the holy Shrines for the success of your consultations.

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Clarification on the Role of
Continental Counselors in
Pioneering and Travel Teaching

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]